

Emergence of the Control Faction in the Japanese Govt

while military was getting stronger ⇒ it was not united.

- was divided between imperial way of faction and control faction
- feud between 2 factions was bitter.

Feb 26 Incident 1936 ⇒ Young officers from imperial way of faction led a military coup

- attempted to assassinate key govt leaders + demanded new govt
- part of their call for Showa restoration, which aimed to restore glory to emperor + defending empire + improving life for ordinary people

Coup failed ⇒ emperor condemned their actions

- 19 leading figures ⇒ in the imperial way faction were arrested, tried in secret military court and executed

Failure of the coup ⇒ caused imperial way of faction to lose its influence within army

- gave control faction opportunity to seize control of military + restore its discipline
Military had so much power influence over cabinet ⇒ was able to appoint active general as Minister for war → who in the past would have been non military person.
 - with strong grip on govt ⇒ Control faction began to prepare for war ⇒ by modernising Japanese military
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